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Systems, devices and methods for reshaping a bodily lumen

Abstract

Aspects of the disclosure include bodily lumen reshaping and reduction systems, devices and methods. Such implants can include a plurality of anchors serially interconnected with a cinching member. Delivery devices of the disclosure are configured to deploy a first anchor into tissue. The delivery device can then deploy a second anchor and wind the cinching member around the second anchor to reduce a distance between the first and second anchors, placating the tissue between the anchors. Additional anchors can be similarly deployed and the cinching member can be similarly adjusted to reshape the lumen. Methods of deploying and reshaping a bodily lumen are also disclosed. In various examples, the bodily lumen is a heart valve, atrial appendage, portion of a gastrointestinal tract or urethra. Various embodiments include one or more anchors having a ratchet assembly or the like to substantially prevent the cinching member from unwinding.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This Non-Provisional patent application claims the benefit of the filing date of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/187,603, filed May 12, 2021, entitled “SYSTEMS, DEVICES AND METHODS FOR RESHAPING A BODILY LUMEN,” the entire teachings of which are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

(1) The present technology is generally related systems, devices and methods for reshaping a bodily lumen. In some examples of the disclosure, the bodily lumen is a heart valve annulus.

BACKGROUND

(2) Generally, the anatomy and physiology of the human heart is well known. Of the four one-way valves in the heart, the two inlet valves are the mitral valve of the left side of the heart, and the tricuspid valve on the right side of the heart. The tricuspid valve is located between the right atrium and the right ventricle. The three leaflets of the tricuspid valve laterally terminate at the tricuspid annulus. Blood flows from the superior and inferior vena cava into the right atrium, then through the tricuspid valve during diastole to fill the right ventricle. During ventricular systole, the tricuspid valve is closed and blood is ejected through the pulmonary valve into the pulmonary artery and hence through the lungs. At the end of ventricular systole the pulmonary valve closes. Leaving the lungs, the now oxygenated blood flows into the left atrium and hence through the mitral valve into the left ventricle during ventricular diastole. Finally, at ventricular systole the mitral valve closes and blood is ejected through the aortic valve into the aorta. However, should the mitral valve become regurgitant due to disease then some percentage of the left ventricular stroke volume will flow backwards through the mitral valve into the left atrium. This regurgitation causes the left atrial pressure to rise, in turn causing pulmonary artery pressure to rise, which is reflected back to the right ventricular pressure.

(3) Typically, to treat a patient with functional mitral regurgitation, a physician places an annuloplasty ring on the mitral annulus to reduce the circumference and septal-lateral diameter of the annulus. In degenerative mitral regurgitation patients, annuloplasty rings are utilized to stabilize the mitral annulus, not reduce the annular circumference.

(4) The present disclosure addresses problems and limitations associated with the related art.

SUMMARY

(5) The techniques of this disclosure generally relate to systems and methods of delivering an implant to a heart valve annulus for resizing of the valve annulus to treat regurgitation. Various examples of the disclosure provide for versatility and control in how multiple segments of the implant are reduced in length to allow patient-specific treatment and optional symmetry in resizing of the valve annulus. In addition, embodiments of the disclosure provide a relatively small delivery system, optionally under 25 French, allowing for increased safety in transcatheter and/or trans-septal delivery of the implant. It is further envisioned that aspects of the disclosure are suitable for reshaping or resizing other bodily lumens such as an atrial appendage, gastrointestinal tract or urethra, for example.

(6) In one aspect, the present disclosure provides an implant including a first anchor and a second anchor, each of the first and second anchors having a head connected to a prong assembly. The implant further includes a cinching member interconnecting the first and second anchors. The cinching member is fixedly connected to the first anchor and is configured to wrap around the second anchor at least one revolution.

(7) In another aspect, the present disclosure provides a system including a catheter defining a first lumen and an implant positioned within the first lumen. The implant has a plurality of anchors connected in series by a cinching member. At least one anchor has a head and a ratchet assembly positioned within the head. The ratchet assembly is configured to restrict movement of the cinching member in one direction.

(8) In another aspect, the present disclosure provides methods of delivering an implant. Such methods can include providing a delivery device including a catheter defining a lumen. The delivery device is provided in a loaded arrangement in which an implant is positioned with the lumen. The implant has a plurality of anchors connected in series by a cinching member. The plurality of anchors include a first anchor and a second anchor. The method further includes delivering a distal end of the catheter to a first target site and deploying the first anchor into the first target site, moving the distal end of the catheter to a second target site and partially deploying the second anchor into the second target site, and rotating the second anchor to wrap the cinching member around the second anchor to shorten a first distance between the first and second anchors.

(9) The details of one or more aspects of the disclosure are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features, objects, and advantages of the techniques described in this disclosure will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a partial, schematic illustration of a system of the disclosure including a catheter in which an implant having a plurality of anchors is positioned for delivery.

(2) FIG. 2 is a partial, schematic illustration of the implant of FIG. 1.

(3) FIGS. 3A-3G illustrate implantation of the implant with the delivery device of FIG. 1 at a heart valve annulus to reshape the valve annulus.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic illustration of an alternate arrangement of two implants implanted at the valve annulus to reshape the valve annulus.

(5) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of an alternate anchor suitable for use with implants of the disclosure.

(6) FIG. 6 is a side view of one anchor of FIGS. 1-2 including optional barbs on a head of the anchor.

(7) FIG. 7 is a side view of one anchor of FIGS. 1-2 including optional bars positioned on one or more prongs of the anchor.

(8) FIG. 8A is a partial, cross-sectional view of an alternate implant including a cinching member interconnecting a plurality of anchors (only one anchor is shown); wherein at least one anchor includes a ratchet assembly.

(9) FIG. 8B is a partial, exploded view of the anchor of FIG. 8A.

(10) FIG. 8C is a top view of the anchor of FIGS. 8A-8B.

(11) FIG. 9 is a perspective view of drive shafts that can be used to rotate components of the anchor of FIGS. 8A-8C.

(12) FIG. 10 is a partial, cross-sectional view of a delivery device that can deliver the implant of FIG. 7, the delivery device including the drive shafts of FIG. 9.

(13) FIG. 11 is a partial, perspective view of the delivery device of FIG. 10.

(14) FIG. 12 is a partial, side view of the implant, which has been implanted to size an annulus.

(15) FIG. 13A is a schematic illustration of an anchor suitable for use with implants of the disclosure, the implant including an alternate ratchet assembly.

(16) FIGS. 13B-13D are schematic top views of the ratchet assembly of FIG. 13A as a cinching member of the implant is wound around the anchor.

- (17) FIGS. **14A-14D** are schematic illustrations of implantation of the anchor of FIG. **13A**, wherein FIGS. **14A-14C** correspond with FIGS. **13B-13D**.
- (18) FIGS. **15A-15C** schematically illustrate a shortening of a distance between adjacent anchors of an implant to resize tissue secured to the implant using the method of FIGS. **14A-14C**.
- (19) FIGS. **16A-16D** illustrate an optional modification to the method of FIGS. **13A-14D** in which a sleeve is positioned between ratchet teeth and a cam of the ratchet assembly to prevent engagement of the cam with the ratchet teeth until desired.
- (20) FIGS. **17A-17E** are schematic illustrations of implantation of the anchor of FIG. **13A**, wherein FIGS. **17A-17D** correspond with FIGS. **16B-16D**.
- (21) FIGS. **18A-18D** schematically illustrate a shortening of a distance between adjacent anchors of an implant to resize tissue secured to the implant using the method of FIGS. **17A-17E**.
- (22) FIGS. **19A-19D** illustrate an alternate method utilizing a locking ring.
- (23) FIGS. **20A-20E** are schematic illustrations of implantation of an, wherein FIGS. **20A-20D** correspond with FIGS. **19B-19D**.
- (24) FIGS. **21A-21D** schematically illustrate a shortening of a distance between adjacent anchors of an implant to resize tissue secured to the implant using the method of FIGS. **20A-20D**.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (25) Specific embodiments of the present disclosure are now described with reference to the figures, wherein like reference numbers indicate identical or functionally similar elements. The terms “distal” and “proximal” are used in the following description with respect to a position or direction relative to the treating clinician. “Distal” or “distally” are a position distant from or in a direction away from the clinician. “Proximal” and “proximally” are a position near or in a direction toward the clinician.
- (26) Referring in particular to FIGS. **1-2**, systems of the disclosure include a delivery device **10** for delivering an implant **12** to a bodily lumen to be resized. In many examples of the disclosure, the bodily lumen or tissue described is a heart valve annulus, such as a mitral or tricuspid valve annulus. Such examples are provided merely as illustrative examples and aspects of the present disclosure are not intended to be limited to any particular bodily lumen. In one example, the delivery device **10** includes a catheter **14** defining a lumen **16** in which the implant **12** is housed for delivery. Implants **12** of the device generally include a plurality of anchors **20a-20c** interconnected with a cinching member **22**. Although only three representative anchors **20a-20c** are shown, additional anchors can be included. It is further envisioned that each of the anchors **20a-20c** can be similarly configured or can be differently configured, as desired. In the example of FIG. **1**, the implant **10** is arranged in the catheter **14** in a loaded arrangement in where the anchors **20a-20c** are stacked. In various embodiments, the cinching member **22** is a flexible, elongated member such as a suture, wire, filament, cord or the like that is suitable for being surgically implanted. In one example, the cinching member **22** is made of aramid fibers. In some embodiments, the cinching member **22** is a single continuous member interconnecting the plurality of anchors **20a-20c**. If all the anchors **20a-20c** are connected with a single cinching member, it may be preferable to have that wire initially extend freely through all the intermediate anchors **20a-20c** (all anchors but the first and last). Having the cinching member **22** extending freely through the intermediate anchors **20b-20c** is believed to provide the physician with the freedom to move each intermediate anchor **20b-20c** as much as desired along the annulus before deployment into the annulus. Such a configuration may also help prevent the next anchor in line from being pulled down and out of the catheter **14** (before such action is intended) while the one before it is being rotated and deployed. In another example, the cinching wire **22** can be fixedly secured to each of the plurality of anchors **20a-20c**.
- (27) In another example, the cinching member **22** may be an assembly comprised of a plurality of discrete segments, one segment fixedly secured to and interconnecting two adjacent anchors **20a-20c**. The implant **10** defines a plurality of segments, each segment including two adjacent anchors (e.g., **20a** and **20b** or **20b** and **20c**) and the cinching member **22** interconnecting the two adjacent

anchors. Embodiments of the disclosure allow for selective length adjustment of the cinching member between the two adjacent anchors, thus correspondingly allowing for selective spacing between the two adjacent anchors.

(28) Anchors **20a-20c** of the disclosure can take many forms. As indicated above, each anchor **20a-20c** of the implant **12** can be identical or can be of a varying configuration. In one example, each anchor **20a-20c** includes a head **30** in which the cinching member **22** is received. In one example, the head **30** includes a channel **32** that can optionally be at least partially exposed to receive the cinching member **22**. Extending from the head **30** is a prong assembly **34, 34'**. The head **30** includes a body **36** defining an opening **38**, which can be a recess, for receiving a drive shaft **40** of the system (see also, FIGS. **3A** and **3B** for example as the drive shaft **40** is omitted in other figures for ease of illustration). In one non-limiting example, the opening **38** can be D-shaped. The drive shaft **40** engages the head **30** and can rotate the respective anchor **20a-20c** to drive the anchor into tissue and/or wrap a portion **23** of the cinching member **22** around the anchor **20a-20c** to shorten a length of the cinching member **22** between adjacent anchors **20a-20c**.

(29) In the examples of FIGS. **1-2**, the prong assembly **34, 34'** may include a plurality of helically intertwined prongs **42** encircling an optional spike **44**. In one example, the distalmost and proximal most anchors do not include a spike (similar to anchor **20a**) and each of the intermediate anchors positioned between the distalmost and proximal most anchors do include the spike **44** similar to anchors **20b, 20c**. The prong assembly **34, 34'** can be made of stainless steel, spring steel, or Nitinol, for example. Optionally, the spike **44** can include a protrusion **46**. In some embodiments, the prong assembly **34, 34'** may include a single helical prong **42**. In some examples, the spike **44** has a length that is longer shorter or equal to a vertical length of the helical prongs **42**.

(30) Referring now in addition to FIGS. **3A-3G** which illustrate one method of the disclosure. The method includes providing the delivery device **10** in a loaded, delivery arrangement having the implant **12** loaded fully within the lumen **16** such that anchors **20a, 20b, 20c, 20d, 20e, 20f, 20g** are stacked within the lumen **16** and the cinching member **22** is serially interconnecting the plurality of anchors **20a-20g**. In the loaded arrangement, the drive shaft **40** is inserted through each of the openings **38** in each respective head **30** of each of the plurality of anchors **20a-20g** as is perhaps best shown in FIG. **3A**. A distal end **24** of the catheter **14** is positioned at a valve annulus A or other bodily lumen to be resized. In one non-limiting example, the valve annulus A is a mitral valve annulus. Once the distal end **24** of the catheter **14** is in the desired starting target site T1, such as a trigone, the implant **12** is distally advanced partially out of the lumen **16** with the drive shaft **40** and a first, distalmost anchor **20a** is driven into the annulus A so that the prong assembly **34** is at least partially within the annulus A. This may include engaging the drive shaft **40** with the head **30** of the most proximal anchor **20f** and pushing the drive shaft **40** to correspondingly push the most proximal anchor. In another embodiment, the anchors **20a-20g** can be configured to be threadably engaged and advanced out of the catheter **14** via rotation of the anchors **20a-20g** along the threads (not shown) via engagement and rotation of the drive shaft **40** or other torqueable apparatus. After the distalmost anchor **20a** is driven into the annulus A, the drive shaft **40** is proximally withdrawn to disengage the drive shaft **40** from the first anchor **20a**. It is noted that the drive shaft **40** is only shown in FIGS. **3A-3B** and is omitted from FIGS. **3C-3F** for ease of illustration. As shown in FIG. **3C**, the distal end **24** of the catheter **14** is moved to a second target site T2 along the annulus A and the second anchor **20b** is advanced out of the lumen **16** and partially driven into the annulus A at the second anchor site with the drive shaft **40**.

(31) FIGS. **3D-3F** are enlarged views of a twisting-to-cinch sequence between a representative pair of anchors **20a, 20b** to reduce a length between the two adjacent anchors **20a, 20b**. FIG. **3D** shows the cinching member **22** before rotation of the anchor **20b** via the drive shaft **40** to wrap the cinching member **22** around the spike **44** of the second anchor **20b**. Wrapping of the cinching member **22**, shortens a length L of the cinching member **22** between the anchors **20a, 20b** which correspondingly pulls the anchors **20a, 20b** together to plicate annulus tissue between the first and

second anchors **20a**, **20b**. It is envisioned that the cinching member **22** can be wrapped around the anchor head **30**, prongs **34** and/or spike **44** to reduce a length of the cinching member **22** between adjacent anchors **20a**, **20b**. FIG. 3E illustrates a mid-point of deployment of the second anchor **20b**, with cinching member **22** partially wrapped around the spike **44**, reducing the length L between the anchors **20a**, **20b** and causing the valve annulus A tissue to plicate. FIG. 3F image shows the second anchor **20b** fully deployed within the valve annulus A tissue and cinching member **22** wrapped around the anchor **20b** additional rotations, with the valve annulus A tissue being further plicated and the wrapped cinching member **22** having slid toward a position adjacent the head **30** of anchor **20b**. Additional anchors (e.g., anchors **20c-20g**) are sequentially deployed in an identical manner around the annulus A and the cinching member **22** is similarly adjusted to plicate tissue between adjacent anchors, as desired. At any stage in the methods of the disclosure, known imaging technologies and techniques may be employed to provide visualization of the implant deployment and adjustment. Once the last, proximal most anchor (e.g., **20g**) of the implant **12** is deployed into the annulus A, the catheter **14** and drive shaft **40** can be withdrawn from the final anchor **20g**, leaving behind only the implant **12** (comprising the plurality of anchors **20a-20g** and the cinching wire **22**) in the anatomy as shown in FIG. 3G, for example. In another method, each anchor can be secured to the valve annulus prior to cinching.

(32) The systems and methods of the disclosure are beneficial as there is no need to sever and remove any excess length of the cinch member after cinching or wrapping around the anchor(s). In addition, since the cinching member is fixed to at least the first and last anchors (e.g., **20a**, **20g**), no locking mechanism to maintain the cinching member is strictly necessary. Also, since the cinching or reshaping of the valve annulus was achieved sequentially through rotation of the anchors, no “final cinch” is required.

(33) In various methods, the implant **12** can be delivered from trigone to trigone, for example as shown in FIG. 3G or two or more implants **112**, **112** of the present disclosure be deployed throughout the annulus as shown in FIG. 4. The implants **112** can be any of those disclosed herein, delivered and deployed in any manner disclosed herein. In one example, each implant **112** is identical to implant **12** except that the implant **112** includes a lesser number of anchors (e.g., four anchors).

(34) The number of rotations to “fully” seat one anchor (see, e.g., FIG. 3F) are, in part, dictated by a pitch of the helically-shaped prong(s) **42** (i.e. length per revolution) and an overall length of the prong(s) **42**, which may be dictated by an avoidance of damaging or perforating adjacent structures, for example. In one example, an implant for achieving about 60 mm of annular reduction includes 6 anchors, each anchor having a length of 5 mm, a prong diameter of 1.62 mm and at least one helical prong having a pitch of 2.54 mm. In this example, each anchor would be rotated 1.97 revolutions for “full” deployment. In yet another example, an implant for achieving about 10 mm of annular reduction includes 14 anchors, each having a length of 8.5 mm, a prong diameter of 0.035 mm and at least one helical prong having a pitch of 1.27 mm. In this example, each anchor could be rotated 6.69 revolutions for “full” deployment. Based on this data, it is envisioned that, in some embodiments of the disclosure, the cinching member will wrap around the prong or head somewhere in a range between 1.5 and 7 revolutions.

(35) Any anchor configuration capable of rotational advancement into annulus tissue is envisioned and considered within the scope of the present disclosure. In the example of FIG. 5, an alternate anchor **20'** includes a head **30'** having an alternate opening **38'** configured to be engaged with a correspondingly shaped drive shaft (similar to drive shaft **40**) and the anchor **20'** includes a prong assembly **34''** having only a spike **44** with a protrusion **46**.

(36) Referring now in addition to FIG. 6, any anchor of the disclosure can optionally include one or more barbs **48** on the head **30**, adjacent the prong assembly **34**. In the example of FIG. 6, anchor **20a** includes barbs **48** extending from the body **36** of the head **30**. In one example, the barbs **48** are angled to restrict disengagement of the prong assembly **34** from the annulus A after the barbs **48**

have been inserted into the annulus. In the alternate embodiment of FIG. 7, any anchor of the disclosure can be modified to include barbs **48'** positioned on one or more prongs **42**. The barbs **48'** are angled to restrict disengaging of the prong assembly **34** from the annulus **A**.

(37) Any implant of the disclosure can include one or more anchors of the disclosure can be configured to include a ratchet assembly to prevent an unraveling of the cinching member during cinching (i.e. wrapping of the cinching member around the anchor). One such delivery device **210** utilizing such anchors **220a**, **220b**, **220c**, **220d** is collectively shown in FIGS. **8A-11**. With reference to FIGS. **8A-8C**, one or more anchors **220b** can include a head **230** and a prong assembly **234** extending from the head. In various embodiments of the disclosure, the cinching member **222** includes at least one looped, hold portion **223a**, and at least one cinching portion **223b**. A body **236** of the head **230** can define a groove **237** in which the hold portion **223a** of the cinching member **222** can freely rotate while the anchor **220b** is being rotatingly driven into tissue. In one example, the cinching member **222** includes one hold portion **223a** positioned around each anchor (e.g., **220a**, **220b**, **220c**, **220d**) of the implant **212** and one cinching portion **223b** arranged to wrap around each intermediate anchor spool **254**. The prong assembly **234** of each anchor (e.g., **220a-220d**) can be any of the types disclosed herein. In the example shown, the prong assembly **234** includes a helical prong **242**. An opening **238** in the body **236** of the head **230** houses the ratchet assembly **250**. In one example, the ratchet assembly **250** includes a lock tube **252** and a spool **254**. The lock tube **252** includes a plurality of cams **256** configured to engage a plurality of teeth **258** of the spool **258**. In one example, the cams **256** are formed from cutouts in the lock tube **252**. As the spool **254** rotates within the lock tube **252**, the plurality of teeth **258** are configured to slide past the cams **256** in one direction (e.g., clockwise) and are configured to be blocked from further movement within slots if the spool **254** rotates in the opposite direction (e.g., counterclockwise). In this way, winding of the cinching member **222** can be maintained around the spool **254**. Should a drive shaft **240**, which is configured to drive the rotation of the spool **254**, be released and tension of the cinch member **222** be at least momentarily lost, the ratchet assembly **250** will substantially maintain the position and tension within the cinch member **222**. Although four cams **256** and four teeth **258** are shown, alternate examples of the disclosure include more or fewer cams **256** and teeth **258**.

(38) The ratchet assembly **250** can take many configurations. In one example, the spool **254** includes a first portion **260**, a second portion **262** and a third portion **264**. The second portion **262** interconnects the first portion **260** to the third portion **264** and has a reduced diameter with respect to the first and third portions **260**, **264** to maintain the spooled cinching member **222** around the second portion **262** as is generally shown in FIG. **7A**. In the example of FIGS. **8A-8C**, the cinching member **222** extends from around the groove **237** into a first aperture **239a** formed in the body **236** to the second portion **262** of the spool **252** where the cinching member **222** can extend approximately 180 degrees to exit a second opening **239b** in the body **236** to extend to the adjacent anchor (e.g., anchor **220c**). During anchor placement, rotation of window **239b** will actively unwind the cinching member **223b**, which is advantageous as to not alter said anchoring position or previous anchor position and integrity.

(39) Referring now in addition to FIG. **9**, the delivery device **210** can be provided with two drive shafts **240a**, **240b**. The first drive shaft **240a** is configured and arranged to extend within an apertures **268**, **270** of the lock tube **250** and spool **254** to an aperture **266** within the body **236** of the head **230**. The first drive shaft **240a** is configured to be able to distally advance (i.e. push the anchor **220b** out of the catheter **14**) and rotatingly drive the anchor **220b** into the annulus or other tissue. The second drive shaft **240b** is configured to selectively engage and rotate the spool **254** to wind the cinching member **222** about the second portion **262**, reducing a length between two adjacent anchors.

(40) The delivery device **210** is best shown collectively in FIGS. **9-11**. In this example, the delivery device **210** includes a catheter **214** having a first lumen **216a** and a second lumen **216b**. The first lumen **216a** intersects the second lumen **216** at junction **217**. The anchors **220a-220c** are spring

loaded into the first lumen **216a** and biased in a distal direction when a drive sheath **260** and drive shafts **240a**, **240b** are retracted. This is done in such a manner that the next anchor within the first lumen **216a** to be deployed enters the second lumen **216b** via biasing (i.e. spring) force placed on the anchors within the first lumen **216a** and the internal geometries of the first lumen **216a** and the second lumen **216b** at junction **217**. Then, the drive shafts **240a**, **240b** and the drive sheath **260** are advanced distally to prevent the next anchor in the series from entering the second lumen **216b** and keeping the cinching member **222** in the interstitial space between the first lumen **216a** and the second lumen **216b**. Having the cinching member **222** in this space prevents the cinching member **222** from becoming tangled around the drive shafts **240a**, **240b** during anchoring of the implant into tissue. In one example, at least a portion of the cinching member **222** is loaded into the first lumen **216b** in a serpentine orientation at position X, similar to fire hose stacking, to allow for stack in the cinching member **222** during loading and deployment of the anchors. This delivery system **210** is believed to be most suitable for implants having a fixed or predetermined number of anchors.

(41) Referring now in addition to FIG. **12**, which illustrates a portion of implant **210** that can be delivered with the delivery device **210**. The implant **212** can include two or more anchors (anchors **220a**, **220b**, **220c** are shown). As illustrated in FIG. **10**, the implant **212** can have at least four anchors **220a**, **220b**, **220c**, **220d**. Each anchor **220a**, **220b**, **220c** can be identically or differently configured. In the illustrated example, the proximal most anchor (not shown) and the distalmost anchor **220a** can be fixedly secured to the cinching member **222**, whereas the cinching member **222** is not fixed to the intermediate anchors (e.g., **220b**, **220c**). In this example, the distalmost anchor **220a** is delivered to and deployed into the tissue or annulus A with the first drive shaft **240a**, which pushes the anchor **220a** distally and rotates the anchor **220a** to drive the prong assembly **234** into the annulus A. Then, the first drive shaft **240a** is proximally withdrawn to disengage from the first anchor **240a** and the catheter **214** is moved to the next target location and then the second anchor **220b** is deployed from the catheter **214** and into the annulus A. The first drive shaft **240a** is again used to engage the second anchor **220b**, drive the second anchor **220b** distally out of the catheter **214**. Rotation of the first drive shaft **240a** correspondingly rotates the body **236** and the prong assembly **234** to at least partially drive the prong assembly **234** into the annulus A. Should placating of the annulus A between the first and second anchors **220a**, **220b** be desired, the second drive shaft **240b** can be engaged with the spool **254** to rotate the spool **254** and wind the cinching member **254** around the second portion **262** to the degree desired to bring the anchors **220a**, **220b** closer together, placating the tissue between the anchors **220a**, **220b**. As the second drive shaft **240b** is winding the cinching member **222**, the ratchet assembly **250** substantially maintains the degree of spooling as the spool **254** cannot be rotated in the opposite direction an amount greater than the location of the next cam **256**. In the example of four equally spaced cams **256**, the maximum amount of unwinding possible would be 90 degrees.

(42) Yet another ratcheting implant **312** and delivery device **310** embodiment is schematically illustrated in FIGS. **13A-15C**. In this example, the implant **312** includes a plurality of anchors **320a**, **320b**, **320c** serially connected by a cinching member **322**, which can be any of the type disclosed herein. Each anchor **320a**, **320b**, **320c** of the implant **312** includes a head **330** having an opening **338** maintaining a ratchet assembly **350** including a ratchet **354** having a plurality of teeth **358** (generally referenced). Extending from an inner surface of the head **330** and into the opening **338** is at least one pawl **356** configured to allow the ratchet **354** to rotate in one direction (e.g., clockwise) but not in the other direction (e.g., counter-clockwise) with respect to the head **330**. Each anchor **320a**, **320b**, **320c** can include a prong assembly **334** and can be otherwise configured similar to any other anchor disclosed herein. One method of deploying the implant **312**, anchors **320** and adjusting a length of the cinching member **322** between adjacent anchors is schematically depicted in FIGS. **14A-15C**. In this example, the delivery device **310** is provided in a loaded state in which the implant **312** is loaded within a lumen **316** of a catheter **314**. The distalmost anchor

320a is deployed out of the catheter **314** and into the annulus A or other tissue at a target site. The catheter **314** is moved to a second target site at the annulus A and, as shown in FIG. 14A, then the next anchor **320b** is advanced out of the catheter **314** with the drive shaft **340**, which can be similarly configured and operate in a manner similar to drive shaft **40** or any other drive shaft disclosed herein. The drive shaft **340** further rotates the anchor **320b** to drive the prong assembly **334** of the anchor **320b** into the annulus A. Rotation of the anchor **320** further wraps the cinching member **322** around the head **330**, to shorten a length of the cinching member **322** between the adjacent anchors (e.g., **320a** and **320b** or **320b** and **320c**), placating the annulus/tissue between the anchors in the process (see FIGS. 14B and 14C as well as FIGS. 3E-3F, for example). The outer member is rotated in the opposite direction of the drive shaft to ensure tension on cinching member **322** only drives the anchor **334** further in, ie not unscrewing it. Then, the catheter **314** and drive shaft **340** are detached from the anchor **340** as shown in FIG. 14D. Additional anchors **320c** of the implant **312** can be implanted in the same manner. FIGS. 15A-15C, schematically illustrate the implantation of the implant **312** having three anchors **320a**, **320b** and **320c** and how the implant **312** is transitioned in the corresponding stages of FIGS. 14A-14C. It is to be understood that the catheter **314**, cinching member **322** and anchor(s) **320a**, **320b**, **320c** can include features disclosed herein with respect to other embodiments having similarly named elements.

(43) The delivery device **310** of FIGS. 14A-14D can be modified as shown in FIGS. 16A-17E to include a sleeve **370** positioned within the lumen **316** of the catheter **314**, and between the ratchet **354** and the pawl **356**. In this example, preventing unwinding (i.e. uncinching or increasing a distance between adjacent anchors) of the cinching member **322** as it is wrapped around the anchor **320b** as is shown in FIG. 17C can be delayed until the sleeve **370** is proximally withdrawn as is shown in FIG. 17D so that the pawl **356** can engage the ratchet teeth **358** (generally referenced; see FIG. 16D). FIGS. 18A-18D, schematically illustrate the implantation of the implant **312** having three anchors **320a**, **320b** and **320c** and how the implant **312** is transitioned in the corresponding stages of FIGS. 17A-17D with the delivery device **310** having the sleeve **370**. It is to be understood that the catheter **314**, cinching member **322** and anchor(s) **320a**, **320b**, **320c** can include features disclosed herein with respect to other embodiments having similarly named elements.

(44) Referring now in addition to FIGS. 19A-21D, which schematically illustrate yet another delivery device **410** for delivering an implant **412** having a plurality of anchors **420a**, **420b**, **420c** (see FIG. 21A) serially connected with a cinching member **422** of any of type of the present disclosure. In this example, one or more anchors **420a**, **420b**, **420c** includes a head **430** having an opening **438** in which a ratchet assembly **450** is provided. Each anchor **420a**, **420b**, **420c** can include a prong assembly **434** and can be otherwise configured similar to any other anchor disclosed herein. The catheter **414** is moved to a target site at the annulus A and, as shown in FIG. 20A, then the next anchor **420b** is advanced out of the catheter **414** with the drive shaft **440**, which can be similarly configured and operate in a manner similar to drive shaft **40** or any other drive shaft disclosed herein. The ratchet assembly **450** includes a ratchet **454** having a plurality of ratchet teeth **458** (generally referenced). The ratchet assembly **450** further includes one or more bosses **456** extending radially inward from an inside surface of the head **430**. The cams **456** are configured to engage the ratchet teeth **458** and restrict rotation of the ratchet **454** in one rotational direction. To fully lock the rotational position of the ratchet **454** with respect to the head **430**, a locking ring **470** can be advanced distally from within a lumen **416** of a catheter **414** of the delivery device **410** to a position between the ratchet **454** and the bosses **456** (FIG. 19D). In one example, the locking ring **470** is advanced by pushing or the like with an inner catheter **472** within lumen **416**. The locking ring **470** is arranged and configured to prevent further rotational movement in either direction (i.e. clockwise or counterclockwise) of the ratchet **454**. In an alternate embodiment, potting adhesive (which could similarly be referenced by reference numeral **470**) could be applied between the ratchet **454** and the bosses **456** with a tool (e.g., **472** or the like) housed within the lumen **416**. Although the ratchet **454** is shown to have four ratchet teeth **458** and the head **430** is shown to have

four bosses 456, fewer or greater number of these respective elements are within the scope of the present disclosure.

(45) It is envisioned that aspects of the disclosure are suitable for a variety of additional treatment applications. For example, systems, devices and methods of the disclosure are believed to be suitable for atrial appendage closure procedures in which an implant of the disclosure is delivered via transcatheter approach for implantation at an atrial appendage for closing the appendage. In addition, systems, devices and methods of the disclosure are believed to be suitable for gastric restriction or diameter reduction procedures in which the implants of the disclosure are anchored within the gastrointestinal tract for gastric reduction. It is further envisioned that systems, devices and methods of the disclosure may be suitable for the treatment of urinary incontinence in which implants of the disclosure can be deployed at the urethra for urethra restriction. In light of the present disclosure, additional bodily lumen reshaping and reduction procedures, which desire a minimally invasive approach, may be accomplished with the techniques of the disclosure.

Therefore, any description or drawing of a bodily lumen that is disclosed herein as an annulus can be interchanged with another bodily lumen or bodily tissue site.

(46) It should be understood that various aspects disclosed herein may be combined in different combinations than the combinations specifically presented in the description and accompanying drawings. It should also be understood that, depending on the example, certain acts or events of any of the processes or methods described herein may be performed in a different sequence, may be added, merged, or left out altogether (e.g., all described acts or events may not be necessary to carry out the techniques). In addition, while certain aspects of this disclosure are described as being performed by a single module or unit for purposes of clarity, it should be understood that the techniques of this disclosure may be performed by a combination of units or modules associated with, for example, a medical device.

Claims

1. A method of delivering an implant, the method comprising: providing a delivery device including a catheter defining a lumen, the delivery device being in a loaded arrangement in which the implant is positioned within the lumen, the implant having a plurality of anchors connected in series by a cinching member, the plurality of anchors including a first anchor, and a second anchor; delivering a distal end of the catheter to a first target site and deploying the first anchor into the first target site; moving the distal end of the catheter to a second target site and partially deploying the second anchor into the second target site; and rotating the second anchor at the second target site to wrap the cinching member around the second anchor to shorten a first distance between the first and second anchors.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the cinching member is wrapped at least one revolution around the second anchor.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the second anchor includes a head connected to a prong assembly.
4. The method of claim 3, wherein the cinching member is wrapped around the prong assembly or the head.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the second anchor includes a ratchet assembly having a cam and a spool around which the cinching member is wrapped, wherein the ratchet assembly restricts rotation of the spool in one direction.
6. The method of claim 5, further comprising a locking sheath positioned between the spool and the cam so that the cam is separated from the spool, the method further comprising withdrawing the locking sheath so that the cam can engage the spool.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of anchors includes a third anchor; wherein the method further includes moving the distal end of the catheter to a third target site and at least

- partially deploying the third anchor into the third target site; the method further including rotating the third anchor at the third target site to wrap the cinching member around the third anchor to shorten a second distance between the second anchor and the third anchor.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the first target site is at a heart valve annulus.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the first target site is an atrial appendage.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein the first target site is within a gastrointestinal tract.
11. The method of claim 1, wherein the first target site is at a urethra.
12. The method of claim 5, wherein the ratchet assembly is disposed within an opening of a head of the anchor.
13. A method of delivering an implant, the method comprising: delivering a distal end of a catheter of a delivery device in a loaded arrangement to a first target site, the catheter defining a lumen in which the implant is positioned in the loaded arrangement, the implant having a plurality of anchors connected in series by a cinching member; deploying a first anchor of the plurality of anchors into the first target site; moving the distal end of the catheter to a second target site; partially deploying a second anchor of the plurality of anchors into the second target site; and rotating the second anchor at the second target site to wrap the cinching member around the second anchor to shorten a first distance between the first and second anchors; and after rotating the second anchor to shorten the first distance, moving the distal end of the catheter to a third target site and partially deploying a third anchor of the plurality of anchors.
14. The method of claim 13, wherein the cinching member is wrapped at least one revolution around the second anchor.
15. The method of claim 13, wherein the second anchor includes a head connected to a prong assembly, and wherein the cinching member is wrapped around the prong assembly or the head.
16. The method of claim 13, wherein the second anchor includes a ratchet assembly having a cam and a spool around which the cinching member is wrapped, wherein the ratchet assembly restricts rotation of the spool in one direction.
17. The method of claim 16, wherein the ratchet assembly is disposed within an opening of a head of the anchor.
18. The method of claim 16, further comprising a locking sheath positioned between the spool and the cam so that the cam is separated from the spool, the method further comprising withdrawing the locking sheath so that the cam can engage the spool.
19. The method of claim 13, further comprising rotating the third anchor at the third target site to wrap the cinching member around the third anchor to shorten a second distance between the second anchor and the third anchor.
20. The method of claim 13, wherein the first target site is at a heart valve annulus.
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